

THE 4T TEACHING ENGINE

The Instructional Model of the Johti Tutor Academy

Teach — Test — Track — Transform

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1. What the 4T Engine Is

The 4T Teaching Engine is the instructional model used in every Johti lesson. Where the Trifecta (JF02) defines the conditions learning requires, the 4T engine defines how tutors teach to create those conditions.

The four phases are Teach, Test, Track, and Transform. They form a repeated cycle — not a one-pass sequence. A strong lesson moves through the cycle multiple times as new ideas emerge and misconceptions are revealed.

Without this cycle, lessons default to explanation-only delivery. The tutor talks; the student listens; understanding is assumed. The 4T engine prevents that collapse by making student thinking visible at every stage.

2. The Four Phases

Phase	What the Tutor Does	Strong Practice	Weak Practice
Teach	Introduces a concept, method, or piece of reasoning with clear step-by-step explanation. Makes the thinking behind each step visible — not just the result. <i>Linked competencies: A1, B2, C1</i>	- Explanation is logically sequenced — each step follows from the previous one - Board work shows reasoning, not just answers - Examples expose why a method works, not only how it works - Pace allows the student to follow without falling behind	- Tutor explains fluently in a way that makes sense to them but not to the student - Steps are skipped — the student must infer missing reasoning - Board shows final answers only - Pace is driven by content coverage, not student understanding

Phase	What the Tutor Does	Strong Practice	Weak Practice
Test	Checks whether explanation has produced genuine understanding — not surface compliance. Uses questions that require the student to explain, justify, predict, or apply reasoning. <i>Linked competencies: C2, C3, D1</i>	- Questions reveal how the student is thinking, not just whether they are correct - Tutor uses the student's answer to decide what to do next - A correct answer is followed by a question that checks the reasoning behind it - Questions expose misconceptions that surface answers would have hidden	'Do you understand?' accepted as evidence of understanding - Questions test recall only — right/wrong with no reasoning required - Tutor moves on after a correct answer without checking whether the reasoning is secure
Track	Observes how the student is applying the idea — through written work, verbal reasoning, hesitation, error patterns. Builds an accurate picture of what the student actually understands. <i>Linked competencies: C3, C4, D1, D2</i>	- Tutor notices hesitation and error patterns — not just final answers - Student's working is visible through board work, Classkick, or verbal explanation - Tutor distinguishes between guessing and reasoning - Patterns across multiple questions reveal whether understanding is secure or fragile	- Tutor monitors only final answers - Correct answers are accepted without checking the route taken to get there - Student appears to understand because they are not asked to show their thinking
Transform	Addresses misunderstanding revealed during Test or Track. Identifies the source of the error and rebuilds reasoning — not just corrects the answer. This is where teaching becomes genuinely responsive. <i>Linked competencies: A2, C4, C5, D3</i>	- Correction targets the source of the error, not just the wrong answer - Student is asked to articulate the corrected reasoning, not just copy it - Tutor contrasts the incorrect and correct reasoning explicitly - Understanding is re-checked after correction — not assumed	- Tutor provides the right answer and moves on - Correction addresses the symptom but not the cause of the misunderstanding - Misconception is corrected once and considered resolved

3. The Engine as a Repeated Cycle

The 4T model is a cycle, not a checklist. In a well-run lesson, the tutor moves through Teach–Test–Track–Transform several times as new concepts emerge, as student responses reveal gaps, and as understanding deepens or stalls.

The cycle length varies. A short explanatory moment followed by a quick diagnostic question, a hesitation noticed, and a brief correction is a full 4T cycle — it may take two minutes. A sustained worked example with extended questioning, careful tracking of written work, and a detailed misconception correction is also a full 4T cycle — it may take twenty.

What the cycle does not do is run once and stop. A lesson that teaches, tests once, and considers the job done is not a Johti lesson. The cycle should recur until the lesson ends.

4. How the 4T Engine Connects to the JTA System

System Element	How the 4T Engine Connects
Jothi Trifecta (JF02)	The Trifecta defines what learning requires. The 4T engine is how tutors create it. Teach and Test address Strategy. Transform develops Mindset by treating mistakes as information. Environment enables all four phases to function.
Lesson Delivery Standard (JTS01)	JTS01 translates the 4T model into observable lesson behaviour — what clear explanation looks like, how diagnostic questioning works, what monitoring student thinking requires in practice.
Digital Board Standard (JTS02)	Board work supports all four phases. It makes the Teach phase visible, creates opportunities for questioning in Test, gives the tutor something concrete to track during Track, and supports precise correction in Transform.
Competency Framework (JTD01)	Every 4T phase maps to specific A-F competency codes. The 4T model is the instructional framework; the competency framework defines the specific skills required to execute each phase well.
Tutor Reflection (JTD02)	The JTD02 reflection form is structured around the 4T cycle. Tutors reflect on each phase after every lesson. This keeps reflection connected to actual teaching behaviour.
Mentor Observation (JTD04)	The JTD04 form uses the 4T cycle as the primary observation lens. Mentors rate each phase and identify which phase is strongest and which needs the most development.

5. What Strong 4T Teaching Looks Like in a Lesson

A tutor applying the 4T model consistently will produce a lesson with the following observable features:

- Explanations are logically sequenced and make reasoning visible — the student can follow why each step follows from the previous one.
- Questions reveal student thinking, not just correct answers. The tutor does not accept surface compliance as evidence of understanding.
- The tutor notices hesitation, written errors, and reasoning gaps — not just final answers.
- Misconceptions are addressed at their source. The student understands the correction, not just the answer.
- The cycle recurs. The lesson does not teach once and then drill. It cycles through Teach–Test–Track–Transform repeatedly as understanding develops.
- The tutor adjusts mid-lesson based on what the Track phase reveals — explanation changes, pace changes, or depth changes in response to evidence.

6. Version Notes — Changes from v1.0

Change	Reason
Phase descriptions presented as a four-column table with strong/weak practice columns	v1.0 described each phase in separate prose sections. The table gives tutors and mentors a direct comparison and is usable as a reference during lesson preparation and observation.
Competency codes linked to each 4T phase	v1.0 did not connect the 4T phases to specific competency codes. v2.0 links each phase to the relevant A-F codes from JTD01 v2.0, making the connection between the teaching model and the competency framework explicit.
Cycle logic made explicit	v1.0 noted the cycle should repeat but did not explain how cycle length varies or what a short cycle versus a full extended cycle looks like. v2.0 addresses this directly.
Separate 'diagnostic questions' section removed	v1.0 devoted a full section to why diagnostic questions matter. This is covered in the Test phase description and in JTS01 v2.0. Removing the duplication keeps JF03 at the right level of abstraction.
All document references updated to v2.0 series	All cross-references now point to the v2.0 versions of JTS01, JTD01, JTD02, and JTD04.

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